

Vernard Mercader

Hybrid UX Designer & Frontend UI Engineer · Active TS/SCI Clearance

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SUMMARY

Hybrid UX Designer and Frontend UI Engineer with over 10 years of cross-functional experience delivering accessible, high-consequence digital products across defense, public-sector, and commercial platforms. Specialist in WCAG 2.1/2.2 AA & AAA compliance, Section 508 accessibility remediation, design system governance, and modern React/TypeScript architectures. Proven track record increasing operational task speed up to 54% in defense intelligence, lifting statewide platform engagement 346% for public health, and reducing production conversion friction for enterprise commercial brands.

CORE COMPETENCIES

ACCESSIBILITY & STANDARDS	WCAG 2.1/2.2 AA & AAA, Section 508, ARIA Semantics, Assistive Tech Audits (Screen Readers, Voice Control), Color Contrast Calibration
UX & PRODUCT DESIGN	Heuristic Evaluation, Journey Mapping, Service Blueprinting, Information Architecture, Usability Testing, Rapid Prototyping, Figma, Miro
FRONTEND ENGINEERING	React, TypeScript, Next.js, Angular, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3/SCSS, Material UI (MUI), Bootstrap, U.S. Web Design System (USWDS)
CLOUD & PLATFORMS	AWS Amplify, GraphQL, REST APIs, Git/GitLab, Docker, DevSecOps, ArcGIS Geospatial COP, WordPress Multisite, Linux

PROFESSIONAL BACKGROUND

Frontend UI Developer	JUL 2026 – PRESENT
Krozak Technologies (United States Coast Guard)	Silver Spring, MD (Remote)

- Design and engineer responsive, accessible **React and TypeScript** user interfaces for Coast Guard applications, translating complex operational UX requirements and Figma wireframes into production component libraries.
- Develop and integrate frontend data workflows utilizing **AWS Amplify, GraphQL, and REST APIs** within an Agile/DevSecOps delivery pipeline.
- Architect mobile-ready and offline-capable interface experiences while enforcing strict adherence to **WCAG 2.1 AA** accessibility standards and military usability baselines.
- Support frontend feature implementation for the U.S. Coast Guard MISLE/MASS common operating picture platform, interfacing **ArcGIS** geospatial layers with AWS Lambda services.

Independent Consultant & Founder	NOV 2025 – PRESENT
Logias (UX & Accessibility Consultancy)	Western Massachusetts

- Increased mobile-order adoption **16%** and reduced customer order complaints by **42%** for Burger King by auditing conversion friction and restructuring pickup location selection flows.
- Delivered comprehensive **WCAG baseline audits and 6-page heuristic evaluations** against Nielsen standards for EDMO (Edventure More), projecting a 20–35% lift in enrollment conversions.
- Authored veteran-player retention audit for Niantic's Pokémon GO, identifying critical cognitive overhead, multi-tap interaction friction, and clunky inventory routines driving user churn.
- Advise enterprise and agency engineering teams on automated and manual Section 508/WCAG compliance remediation backed by functional code sandboxes.

UI Engineer & UX Design Lead	MAY 2023 – NOV 2025
Oteemo (United States Air Force – Platform One)	Reston, VA (Remote)

- Elevated internal accessibility score from **62 to 91 points** by directing the UI overhaul and brand transition of the Vulnerability Assessment Tool (VAT) for Iron Bank under Platform One.
- Rearchitected frontend infrastructure by migrating legacy Bootstrap to **Material UI (MUI) in React TypeScript**, enforcing Section 508 accessibility compliance and dark/light modes.
- Decreased pull request cycle times by **10%** through a unified Figma-to-code design system and automated repo-level semantic HTML and ARIA linting routines.
- Facilitated discovery sessions with container hardeners and vendor contributors using FigJam and Miro, turning behavioral pain points into verified interactive prototypes.

ENTERPRISE & PUBLIC-SECTOR EXPERIENCE

Continued Timeline

Senior UX Designer

DEC 2021 – APR 2023

M-Corp (California Department of Public Health)

Sacramento, CA (Remote)

- Increased daily active application sessions by **346%** (from 5 to 22 daily school district operators) by re-architecting the statewide CAIRHub immunization platform and delivering a 0-to-1 design system.
- Achieved **100% WCAG 2.1 AA compliance** for all reviewed CAIRHub modules through accessible data table patterns, keyboard-only traversal, and responsive color tokens.
- Bridged UX discovery with engineering delivery by authoring **Angular and React TypeScript** component specs, design tokens, and Section 508 audit registers for cross-functional developers.
- Facilitated statewide stakeholder alignment workshops including Feature Priority Matrices, Service Blueprinting, and Design Thinking sessions to accelerate roadmap delivery.

Lead UX Designer

APR 2020 – DEC 2021

SAIC (USAF Shadow Operations Center, Nellis AFB)

Nellis AFB, NV (Hybrid / SCIF)

- Reduced intelligence operator mission task completion times by **24% to 54%** (60–70 seconds saved per event) by designing the SHROUD GIS coordinate-parsing middleware directly inside the operational chat interface.
- Redesigned "Hyve" primary operational communications tool within a secure **SCIF TS/SCI environment**, conducting field discovery via direct floor immersion and pen-and-paper workflow mapping.
- Spearheaded the ShOC design system as a secure fork of the **U.S. Web Design System (USWDS)**, translating Figma specifications into functional React TypeScript code.
- Coached cross-functional engineering teams on military human-computer interaction guidelines, strict accessibility standards, and Agile delivery.

UX Lead & Frontend Developer

JAN 2019 – MAR 2020

GetDocsNow

Las Vegas, NV

- Re-engineered customer self-service portal with mobile-first responsive architecture, semantic HTML structure, and modernized CSS typography, boosting HOA member task completion rates.
- Developed customer-facing interactive features using **C#, ASP.NET, and modern JavaScript**, tracing complex business logic to resolve production data bottlenecks.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & CLEARANCE

Bachelor of Science in Digital Entertainment & Game Design

ITT Tech · Everett, WA

Associate of Applied Science in Multimedia / Design

ITT Tech-Everett · Everett, WA

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

Lyceum University · Manila, Philippines

Active TS/SCI Security Clearance

Department of Defense / Federal Adjudication (Initial 2021, Reinvestigated 2026)

Google UX Design Professional Certificate

Coursera / Google Career Certification

Adobe Certified Expert (ACE) & Professional (ACP)

Illustrator, InDesign, Photoshop, Express, Premiere Pro, After Effects

Interaction Design Foundation (IxDF) Certified

UX Management, Accessibility in Practice, HCI, AI for Designers, Design Thinking